Brigham Young University-Idaho

Senior Practicum: ED 449
Standards, Outcomes, and Course Structure

Part I: Course Introduction

Description: This course is a clinical course in teaching in which students are placed in schools two times per week (practicum) and meet together for instruction once per week (seminar). The purpose of this course is to build teaching capacity in students, specifically: long-term planning, behavior management, professionalism, unit and lesson planning, assessment, and reflection.

Class Time & Place: M 9-11 HIN 171. Wed/Fri at school site (full day).

Part II: Mission, Outcomes, Standards, and Alignment

The BYU-Idaho Teacher Education Department Vision:

Follow the example of the Savior to become outstanding educators who empower learners to reach their divine potential

BYU Idaho Mission Statement and Institutional Learning Objectives: BYU-Idaho's mission is to develop disciples of Jesus Christ who are leaders in their homes, the Church, and their communities.

BYU Idaho Institutional Learning Objectives:

1. **Disciples of Jesus Christ:** Disciples of Jesus Christ have a testimony of Jesus Christ as the Son of God and strive to follow Him.
    1) Understand Doctrine and Principles of the Restored Gospel
    2) Make and Keep Covenants
    3) Live Standards of Honor and Integrity
    4) Work as Faithful Stewards of The Lord

2. **Sound thinkers:** Sound thinkers frame and solve problems using creative and critical thinking.
    1) Problem Solving
    2) Critical Thinking
    3) Inquiry and Analysis
    4) Innovation/Creativity

3. **Effective Communicators:** Effective communicators develop and express ideas that are purposeful, organized, and clear.
    1) Structure Content to Accomplish Specific Purposes
    2) Follow Appropriate Processes of Content Development
    3) Address Targeted Audiences Using Appropriate Modes of Delivery
    4) Express Ideas Clearly

4. **Skilled Collaborators:** Skilled collaborators work effectively with others to accomplish a shared vision.
    1) Fulfill Individual Responsibilities
    2) Facilitate Contributions of Others
    3) Foster Productive Group Climates
    4) Respond to Conflicts in Constructive Ways

How does this relate to our class?
I work very hard to make sure that this class is aligned to the university's ILOs. Let me give just a few examples: We will be working together in groups (ILO 4.2) to teach each other techniques of highly-effective teachers (ILO 2.2). You will use GoReact (ILO 3.3) to record your teaching, then reflect on it, and you will also give feedback to peer lessons (ILO 4.3) We review the skills of professionalism that allow you to navigate workplace politics (ILO 4.4) and teach you mindsets of personal dedication and internal locus of control (ILO 4.1) that will allow you to be totally successful in you chosen career. I suspect there are more ties--but I hope you can feel the light and inspiration coming from these. They have been crafted through inspiration, and striving to live up to them will be a blessing to you.

Course Overview:
This course will give you guided classroom experience and the opportunity to prepare and teach in the public-school classroom. Senior practicum also includes a seminar for the discussion of principles of learning and teaching as you get ready to go into student teaching. You will write and teach well-prepared lesson plans, you will write and teach a complete unit of study as well, which includes all of the following: designating the teaching/learning context in which you will be working, exploring the essential questions that define your unit, creating a big idea that will guide you as you prepare the lessons; deciding what students must know, understand, and do (KUDos) as a result of your teaching; developing an effective curriculum map; writing, administering, and analyzing the results of pre- and post-tests; creating meaningful lesson plans, reflecting on your teaching practices, and gathering samples of student work.

Course Vision:
Our vision and purpose in the teacher education department is to follow the example of the Savior to become outstanding educators who empower learners to reach their divine potential.

Senior practicum is the class that immediately precedes your student-teaching experience. As a result, our goal for the course is to help you reach toward the vision becoming an outstanding educator who directs children to reach toward their divine potential as children of our Heavenly father by giving you supported, guided experiences in real-world classrooms within a framework that aligns with the State of Idaho Standards for Elementary Education Teachers which follow:

1. Learner Development. The teacher understands how learners grow and develop, recognizing that patterns of learning and development vary individually within and across the cognitive, linguistic, social, emotional, and physical areas, and designs and implements developmentally appropriate and challenging learning experiences.

2. Learning Differences. The teacher uses understanding of individual differences and diverse cultures and communities to ensure inclusive learning environments that enable each learner to meet high standards.

3. Learning Environments. The teacher works with others to create environments that support individual and collaborative learning, and that encourage positive social interaction, active engagement in learning, and self-motivation.

4. Content Knowledge. The teacher understands the central concepts, tools of inquiry, and structures of the discipline(s) he or she teaches and creates learning experiences that make the discipline accessible and meaningful for learners to assure mastery of the content.

5. Application of Content. The teacher understands how to connect concepts and use differing perspectives to engage learners in critical thinking, creativity, and collaborative problem solving related to authentic local and global issues.

6. Assessment. The teacher understands and uses multiple methods of assessment to engage learners in their own growth, to monitor learner progress, and to guide the teacher's and learner's decision making.

7. Planning for Instruction. The teacher plans instruction that supports every student in meeting rigorous learning goals by drawing upon knowledge of content areas, curriculum, cross- disciplinary skills, and pedagogy, as well as knowledge of learners and the community context.

8. Instructional Strategies. The teacher understands and uses a variety of instructional strategies to encourage learners to develop deep understanding of content areas and their connections, and to build skills to apply knowledge in meaningful ways.

9. Professional Learning and Ethical Practice. The teacher engages in ongoing professional learning and uses evidence to continually evaluate his/her practice, particularly the effects of his/her choices and actions on others (learners, families, other professionals, and the community), and adapts practice to meet the needs of each learner.

Course Outcomes:

- Differentiate universally designed instruction to meet the needs of all students, by modifying curriculum, accommodating for needs, and enriching/remediating (e.g., using multiple means of representation, engagement, representation of learning). {Idaho Elementary Education Standards 2(K1, P2)}
- Create a lesson plan: Implement rules and procedures that are structured to support effective learning (e.g., transitions, expectations, material management.
- Manage a classroom: Guide students to self-assess their learning and self-monitor their performance {Idaho Elementary Education Standards 3(P1, 2)}
- If you're looking to hide penguins, I always put them in the standards/course outcomes. They blend in well. Andrea keeps trying to find them all, and hasn't yet. We'll see if she finds this one. :D
- Teach self-assessment skills: Use assessment data to design and deliver instruction effectively in the context of the classroom to which you are assigned to (e.g., consider background/culture of each student, the purpose of learning the content, how the content will be used) {Idaho Elementary Education Standards 6}
- Design effective instruction from assessment data {Idaho Elementary Education Standards 6}
- Engage all children in learning Intentionally implement instruction that is clear, specific, and engaging (e.g., use effective questioning and discussion techniques): {Idaho Elementary Education Standards 5, 8(P1)}
- Perform in a professional way (e.g. Reflect on their practice objectively and grow as a result of that reflection, keep accurate records, dress professionally, advocate for students, collaborate with peers, etc…) {Idaho Core Standards 9(P3, 5, 4, D3), 10(K3,4, P1, D3)}
- Be guided by the Spirit as you plan and teach.

Required Common Assessments:

All senior practicum students at BYU-Idaho are assessed in the following ways:

- **Supervisor Evaluation:** Your university supervisor (that's BroPa) will evaluate you in accordance with the four domains of the Danielson framework: 1, Planning and preparation; 2, Classroom environment; 3, Instruction; 4, Professional Responsibilities. You should be able to demonstrate effectiveness with creating clear lesson outcomes, content delivery, student engagement, design for accessibility, classroom management and culture, and so on. Your mentor and supervisor will also evaluate your overall professionalism.
- **Capstone Unit Plan:** You will backwards plan and teach a complete unit of instruction. The unit plan is the major project of this course. Teacher-candidates will be required to formulate essential questions, "KUDos" (what students will know, understand, and do) and alignment of standards and objectives. Then, candidates will create assessments (both pre- and post-assessments) and will engage in intentional data analysis. Candidates will use that analysis to differentiate and remediate. Candidates will develop an instructional calendar that includes summative assessments, remediation and extension possibilities, and complete a written reflection on the entire process. You will also be required to submit several artifacts of student work, including assessments.
- **Senior Portfolio:** You will be required to complete a portfolio of your best work from across your college experience.